Histories as Events: the Order of the Pair Rule, First-Order Weights and Forces from Gains of Bounded Order

Kirtus Justus

Theoretical Physicist

Port Coquitlam, British Columbia, Canada

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Abstract

On a gain digraph, a family of set functions on walks of each length is one function on sets of unending walks exactly when the measure of a set of walks equals, up to a fixed factor, the measure of the set of all its continuations. Under that condition an additive rule is a multiple of the number of walks, so the weighting of returning walks by their holonomy that invariance under switching allows is excluded. On the signed arc digraph of a line, a rule that adds over end vertices a function of the modulus of the summed gains satisfies the condition only if the function is the square, and the same holds on every finite connected signed digraph that is norm-preserving of degree two; on any norm-preserving gain digraph in which two walks merge, the only power of the modulus that satisfies it is the second. For gains in the q-th roots of unity the rules of this form that satisfy it are exactly the combinations of the squared moduli in the conjugate characters, a space of dimension $\varphi(q)/2$, of dimension one for $q = 2$, so that the rule is unique up to a factor exactly for the orders 2, 4 and 6: the condition forces the order of the rule and leaves the embedding of the amplitudes undetermined. Multiplicativity on products of carriers reduces the freedom to the choice of one conjugate character. If the gain of a walk is itself a record, the carrier is a signed lift, on which the rule is unique for every order and is the mean of the squared moduli over the characters in which -1 acts as -1; the choice of an embedding belongs to the reduction by a character. Among the switching-invariant pair rules, with no choice of records and for any finite abelian group of gains and any degree, the consistent ones are exactly the mixtures over the characters for which the step is norm-preserving; in degree two these are the characters in which -1 acts as -1. The second order of the pair rule of paper G8 thus follows from the condition, the form of the rule and the carrier. A position-dependent gain translates the quasi-momentum exactly only if it is linear in position, so a translation by Φ per step needs gains of order at least $2\pi/\Phi$. For gains of order three or more no quasi-energy lies in the spectrum of the free step multiplied by every gain value, apart from four band edges for order four; in computed instances a staircase of gains of order three, four or six confines a walk to a block, leaks slowly or is a strong field, and does not follow the ray of its mean field. For a linear gain the centroid of a packet follows the ray averaged over the packet, displaced by the connection of the branch eigenvector, with a remainder that falls about as the first power of the field in the instances computed. The statements are conditional on the

event structure, the form of the rule and the carrier. Neither quantum nor classical mechanics is derived, and no physical correspondence is asserted.

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1 Question and results

Paper G8 assigns a measure to sets of walks of one length on a gain graph, and leaves three items as assumptions: the second order of the rule, the exclusion of a first-order weighting of returning walks, and any relation between the measures at different lengths [8]. Paper G9 takes the simplest such relation, consistency under continuation, as a requirement and finds what it forces on the carrier [9]. It leaves open a reason for the requirement, an error bound for the position of a ray, and whether gains of bounded order can imitate a weak force. The present paper asks what the same requirement decides about the rule itself, and returns to the two open items.

(i) On a digraph in which every vertex has an outgoing arc, a family of set functions on walks of each length from one vertex defines one function on sets of unending walks exactly when it is consistent under continuation (Lemma 3.1). The requirement of G9 is thus the statement that events are sets of histories.

(ii) An additive rule that is consistent under continuation is a multiple of the number of walks: the weighting of returning walks by their holonomy, which switching invariance allows, is excluded (Proposition 4.1).

(iii) On the signed arc digraph of a line, a rule that adds over end vertices a function of the modulus of the summed gains is consistent under continuation only if that function is the square (Theorem 5.1); the same holds on every finite connected signed digraph that is norm-preserving of degree two (Theorem 5.3). On any norm-preserving gain digraph with a merging pair of walks, the only consistent power of the modulus is the second (Theorem 5.2). For gains in the q-th roots of unity the consistent rules of this form are exactly the combinations of the squared moduli in the conjugate characters; they form a space of dimension $\varphi(q)/2$ for $q > 2$ and of dimension one for $q = 2$, and the rule is unique up to a factor exactly for $q \in \{2, 4, 6\}$ (Theorem 5.5). Such a rule is non-negative exactly when its weights are, and if it is multiplicative on products of carriers it is the squared modulus in one conjugate character (Proposition 5.6). If the gain of a walk is itself recorded, so that the carrier is the signed lift with one sheet for each pair of opposite gains, the rule is unique for every q: it is the square of the integer amplitude, the mean of the squared moduli over the characters in which -1 acts as -1 (Corollary 5.7). Without any choice of records, for any finite abelian group of gains and any degree, the consistent switching-invariant pair rules of [8] are exactly the mixtures of the squared-norm rules of the characters for which the step is norm-preserving (Theorem 5.8). In degree two these are the characters in which -1 acts as -1, the kernel changes sign under -1, and for the q-th roots of unity the space has dimension $\lceil q/4 \rceil$ and contains both families (Corollary 5.9). For blocks of degree three and four with gains of order 3, 6 or 4 a consistent rule that adds a function of the modulus over end vertices is again the square (Proposition 5.10); for blocks $\rho_z \kappa_y w^{zy}$ of every degree d dividing q the consistent rules of that form are exactly the combinations of the conjugate squared moduli, as in degree two (Theorem 5.11). Finally the form of the blocks is not needed at all: on every norm-preserving carrier, of any degree, in which two vertices have a common successor and the events at them are rich enough, the consistent rules of that form are exactly the combinations of the conjugate squared moduli (Theorem 5.12, Corollary 5.13). On a finite carrier whose derived digraph is strongly connected no hypothesis on events is needed: the order that enters is that of the gains that can meet at one length (Proposition 5.14, Corollary 5.15). On carriers with full blocks, which include every norm-preserving digraph of

degree two, the modulus is not needed either: a consistent rule that adds over end vertices any function of the summed gains is a quadratic form, and if it is unchanged by switching it is a combination of the conjugate squared moduli (Theorem 5.16, Corollary 5.17).

(iv) A gain that depends on position translates the quasi-momentum by a fixed amount per step exactly only if it is the linear gain; a translation by Φ therefore needs a gain of order at least $2\pi/\Phi$ (Proposition 6.1). For gains of order $q \geq 3$ no quasi-energy belongs to the spectra of the free step multiplied by all q gain values, except four band edges for $q = 4$ (Proposition 6.2). Computed instances of staircases of gains of order 3, 4 and 6 are recorded in Section 6; none follows the ray of its mean field.

(v) For the linear gain, the centroid of a packet follows the ray averaged over the quasi-momentum distribution of the packet, displaced by the connection of the branch eigenvector, with a remainder that decreases about as the first power of the field in the instances computed (Section 7). No bound is proved.

Section 8 states what is assumed and what is not obtained. The statements are mathematical and concern the constructed trials GH-1 and GH-2 of the program collection. Neither quantum nor classical mechanics is derived.

2 Setting

The notation is that of [9]. A gain digraph D has a finite or countable vertex set V, arcs e with initial vertex $s(e)$, terminal vertex $t(e)$ and gain $\varphi(e)$ in a group G, at most one arc from a given vertex to a given vertex, and finitely many arcs leaving each vertex; a character $\chi\colon G \to \mathrm{U}(1)$ is fixed and $A_{yx} = \chi(\varphi(e))$ for an arc e from x to y, $A_{yx} = 0$ if there is none. An event S is a set of walks of one length j from one vertex x, with vector $v_S(y) = \sum_{w \in S,\, t(w)=y} \chi(\varphi(w))$, and $\operatorname{Ext} S$ is the event of all walks of length $j+1$ whose first j arcs form a walk of S; $v_{\operatorname{Ext} S} = A v_S$. A family $(\mu_j)_{j\geq 0}$ of real functions on the events of each length is *consistent under continuation with factor* $c > 0$ if

$$\mu_{j+1}(\operatorname{Ext} S) = c\,\mu_j(S) \qquad \text{for every event } S \text{ of every length } j. \tag{2.1}$$

A *rule* gives μ_j by one formula for all j. The rule of [8] is $\mu(S) = \|v_S\|^2$; by Lemma 3.1 of [9] it satisfies (2.1) for all events exactly when $A^*A = c$ on the vectors concerned, and D is then called norm-preserving of degree c.

3 Events as sets of histories

Suppose every vertex has an outgoing arc. A *history* from x is an unending walk $(e_1, e_2, \dots)$ with $s(e_1) = x$. For a walk w of length j from x let $\operatorname{cyl}(w)$ be the set of histories whose first j arcs are w, and for an event S let $\operatorname{cyl}(S) = \bigcup_{w\in S} \operatorname{cyl}(w)$. For a fixed starting vertex the sets $\operatorname{cyl}(S)$ form an algebra of subsets of the histories from that vertex, the algebra of cylinder sets. The assumption on outgoing arcs is needed: a walk that ends at a vertex without one has an empty cylinder.

Lemma 3.1. *Let every vertex have an outgoing arc, and fix a starting vertex; events and histories are those from that vertex.*

(a) $\operatorname{cyl}(\operatorname{Ext} S) = \operatorname{cyl}(S)$*, and for events* S, S' *of lengths* $j \leq j'$ *one has* $\operatorname{cyl}(S) = \operatorname{cyl}(S')$ *if and only if* $S' = \operatorname{Ext}^{j'-j} S$*.*

(b) A family (ν_j) of functions on events defines a function ν on the algebra of cylinder sets by $\nu(\mathrm{cyl}\,S) = \nu_j(S)$ if and only if $\nu_{j+1}(\mathrm{Ext}\,S) = \nu_j(S)$ for all S and j.

(c) A family (μ_j) is consistent under continuation with factor c if and only if $\nu_j = c^{-j}\mu_j$ defines a function on the algebra of cylinder sets.

Proof. (a) A history begins with a walk of S exactly when its first $j+1$ arcs form a walk of $\mathrm{Ext}\,S$. If $\mathrm{cyl}(S) = \mathrm{cyl}(S')$, a walk w' of length j' lies in S' exactly when the histories beginning with w' lie in $\mathrm{cyl}(S)$; since every walk is the beginning of a history, this holds exactly when the first j arcs of w' form a walk of S. (b) follows from (a), and (c) from (b). □

Condition (2.1) is therefore not a dynamical law added to the rule. It says that an event is a set of histories, and that the measure of a set of histories does not depend on the length at which the set is described. For a system of finitely many states with a unitary step the decoherence functional of Dowker, Johnston and Surya is defined on exactly this algebra, with cylinder sets of finite strings as generators [6]; they show that it does not extend to the generated σ-algebra in general, which is not used here. That events are sets of histories is an assumption about the event structure. It is supplied. What follows is what it decides once it is made.

4 Additive rules

By Lemma 3.1 of [8] a switching-invariant additive rule has the form $\mu(S) = \sum_{w\in S} F(w)$ with $F(w) = a$ for a walk that does not end at its starting vertex and $F(w) = F_{\mathrm{c}}(\varphi(w))$, a class function of the gain, for a walk that does. Such a rule is consistent under continuation with factor c exactly when

$$\sum_{e\colon\, s(e)=t(w)} F(we) = c\,F(w) \qquad \text{for every walk } w \text{ from } x. \tag{4.1}$$

Proposition 4.1. *Let D be a gain digraph without loops in which every vertex has $d \geq 1$ outgoing arcs, and let an additive rule of the form above satisfy* (4.1) *with a factor $c > 0$. If $a \neq 0$, then $c = d$ and $F_{\mathrm{c}}(g) = a$ for every g that is the gain of a closed walk at x. If $a = 0$, then $F_{\mathrm{c}}(g) = 0$ for every such g. In both cases μ is a times the number of walks.*

Proof. A closed walk w at x with gain g has d continuations, none of them closed, since there are no loops; so (4.1) reads $da = cF_{\mathrm{c}}(g)$. If $a = 0$ this gives $F_{\mathrm{c}}(g) = 0$. Let $a \neq 0$. If some walk from x ends at a vertex $y \neq x$ without an arc to x, its continuations are open and (4.1) reads $da = ca$, so $c = d$ and then $F_{\mathrm{c}}(g) = a$. Otherwise every walk w ending at $y \neq x$ has exactly one closed continuation, with some gain g', and (4.1) reads $(d-1)a + F_{\mathrm{c}}(g') = ca$. Every closed walk of positive length arises in this way, so F_{c} has the single value $f = (c-d+1)a$ on their gains; with $da = cf$ this gives $(c-d)(c+1) = 0$, hence $c = d$ and $f = a$. The closed walk of length 0 gives $da = cF_{\mathrm{c}}(1)$ and the same value. □

The weights 2 and $1/2$ of the example of Directors A, B and G for $\mathbb{Z}_3$, quoted after Lemma 3.1 of [8], are thus not the values of a function on sets of histories: on the complete graph on four vertices with one gain of order three the ratios in (4.1) take the values 1.5, 2.5 and 4 on walks of length two [2]. For two triangles with a common vertex, where the out-degrees are 2 and 4, no factor among those tried makes a rule

with $a \neq 0$ consistent [2]. A first-order rule on histories is the count of walks, which is the uniform classical measure on histories and does not depend on the gains.

5 Rules that depend on the modulus

Let $\phi\colon [0,\infty) \to \mathbb{R}$ with $\phi(0) = 0$, and put

$$\mu_\phi(S) = \sum_{y \in V} \phi(|v_S(y)|). \tag{5.1}$$

This keeps two assumptions of [8]: gains of walks with a common end vertex are added, and end vertices are records over which the rule adds. It drops the second order. The rule of [8] is $\phi(t) = t^2$, its rule of fourth order is $\phi(t) = t^4$, and with trivial gains $\phi(t) = t$ is the number of walks.

5.1 The signed line

Let D be the signed arc digraph of the line $\mathbb{Z}$ of [9]: vertices (x, R) and (x, L), arcs from either to $(x+1, R)$ and to $(x-1, L)$, all gains $+1$ except -1 on the arcs from (x, L) to $(x-1, L)$. The vectors v_S have integer components, so only the values of ϕ at integers enter.

Theorem 5.1. *On the signed arc digraph of the line, the rule* (5.1) *with* $\phi(1) \neq 0$ *is consistent under continuation with a factor* $c > 0$ *if and only if* $c = 2$ *and* $\phi(n) = n^2\phi(1)$ *for every integer* $n \geq 0$*.*

Proof. For one walk w, $\mu_\phi(\{w\}) = \phi(1)$ and $\mathrm{Ext}\{w\}$ consists of two walks with different end vertices, so $2\phi(1) = c\,\phi(1)$ and $c = 2$. Let $a \geq 1$. A walk from $(0, R)$ is a sequence of steps to the right and to the left, and its gain is -1 to the power of the number of steps to the left that follow a step to the left. Among the walks of length $a+1$ with a steps to the right and one to the left there are a that end with a step to the right and one that ends with the step to the left; all have gain $+1$ and end at site $a-1$. Let S consist of these $a+1$ walks. Then v_S has the components a at $(a-1, R)$ and 1 at $(a-1, L)$ and no others, and $v_{\mathrm{Ext}\,S} = Av_S$ has the components $a+1$ at (a, R) and $a-1$ at $(a-2, L)$. Consistency gives

$$\phi(a+1) + \phi(a-1) = 2\phi(a) + 2\phi(1), \qquad a \geq 1,$$

and with $\phi(0) = 0$ induction gives $\phi(n) = n^2\phi(1)$. Conversely $A^*A = 2$ and $\phi(t) = t^2$ is consistent by Lemma 3.1 of [9]. □

The recursion is the parallelogram identity $\phi(|a+b|)+\phi(|a-b|) = 2\phi(|a|)+2\phi(|b|)$ at $b = 1$; the full identity holds at every site because the two arcs arriving at a site continue to one vertex with equal signs and to another with opposite signs, which is the zigzag gain -1 of Theorem 4.3 of [9]. A numerical solution of the consistency equations over 4000 sampled events of length 12 returns $\phi(n)/\phi(1) = n^2$ for $n \leq 8$ to 3×10^{-13}, and rejects $\phi(n) = n$ and $\phi(n) = n^4$ [2]. With all gains $+1$ on the same digraph the rule $\phi(t) = t$ is consistent, being the count.

5.2 Norm-preserving digraphs

Theorem 5.2. *Let D be a gain digraph with a character χ of modulus one and $A^*A = d$, $d \geq 2$. Suppose two walks of equal length from a common vertex end at distinct vertices y_1, y_2 that have a common successor. Then for $p > 0$ the rule $\mu_p(S) = \sum_y |v_S(y)|^p$ is consistent under continuation with some factor $c > 0$ if and only if $p = 2$.*

Proof. Single walks give $c = d$, as every vertex has d successors. Let w_1, w_2 be the two walks, a, b the values of χ on their gains, and $S = \{w_1, w_2\}$, so $\mu_p(S) = 2$. Let Z be the set of the $m \geq 1$ common successors of y_1, y_2. For $z \in Z$ the component of Av_S is $aA_{zy_1} + bA_{zy_2}$, of modulus $|1 + u_z|$ with $u_z = (b/a)\,\overline{A_{zy_1}}A_{zy_2}$; the other $2(d - m)$ successors carry components of modulus one. Orthogonality of the columns y_1, y_2 of A gives $\sum_{z\in Z} u_z = 0$. Hence $\mu_p(\operatorname{Ext} S) = 2(d - m) + h(p)$ with $h(p) = \sum_{z\in Z} |1 + u_z|^p$, and consistency requires $h(p) = 2m$. Now $h(2) = \sum_z (2 + 2\operatorname{Re} u_z) = 2m$. For $t \geq 0$ the inequality between the weighted arithmetic and geometric means of 1 and t^2 gives $t^p \leq (1 - \frac{p}{2}) + \frac{p}{2}t^2$ for $0 < p < 2$, and that of 1 and t^p gives $t^2 \leq (1 - \frac{2}{p}) + \frac{2}{p}t^p$ for $p > 2$, with equality only at $t = 1$. Summing over $z \in Z$ with $t = |1 + u_z|$ and $h(2) = 2m$: $h(p) \leq (1 + \frac{p}{2})m < 2m$ for $p < 2$, and $h(p) \geq (1 + \frac{p}{2})m > 2m$ for $p > 2$. This termwise argument replaces a convexity argument of earlier issues; it was found in a formal proof and is checked in Lean 4 with Mathlib [2]. □

Theorem 5.3 (Degree two)**.** *Let D be a finite gain digraph with gains ± 1 that is norm-preserving of degree two and whose underlying graph is connected. The rule* (5.1) *with $\phi(1) \neq 0$ is consistent under continuation with a factor $c > 0$ if and only if $c = 2$ and $\phi(n) = n^2\phi(1)$ for every integer $n \geq 0$.*

Proof. Single walks give $c = 2$. By Theorem 4.3 of [9] every vertex has two incoming and two outgoing arcs, so D is strongly connected, and the vertices fall into blocks: pairs $\{x, x'\}$ with common successors $\{y, y'\}$ and signs $s_1 = A_{yx}$, $s_2 = A_{yx'}$, $s_3 = A_{y'x}$, $s_4 = A_{y'x'}$ with $s_1s_2s_3s_4 = -1$. Fix a block and a starting vertex. Let B be the matrix of the numbers of arcs; $B/2$ is doubly stochastic and irreducible, with some period r, so the number of walks of length j from the starting vertex to a given vertex tends to infinity as $j \to \infty$ through the lengths of one residue class modulo r and is zero for the other lengths. Because x and x' have a common successor, their residue classes coincide. Given $n \geq 1$ choose a length with at least $2n - 1$ walks to x and one walk to x'; among the former, n have equal gains. Let S consist of these n walks and one walk to x'. Then v_S has the components $\pm n$ at x and ± 1 at x' and no others, and Av_S has the components $s_1(\pm n) + s_2(\pm 1)$ at y and $s_3(\pm n) + s_4(\pm 1)$ at y', of moduli $n + 1$ and $n - 1$ in some order because $s_1s_2 = -s_3s_4$. Consistency gives $\phi(n + 1) + \phi(n - 1) = 2\phi(n) + 2\phi(1)$, and the conclusion follows as in Theorem 5.1. The converse is Lemma 3.1 of [9]. □

Theorem 5.3 covers the rings and every other carrier of the constructed trial GH-2 with real gains; the choice of the base digraph does not matter. For 40 random carriers of this kind on up to twelve vertices, and for 10 carriers with gains of order four, where the moduli are those of Gaussian integers, a numerical solution of the consistency equations returns the square [2]; gains that are not real are treated in the next subsection. A first version of that computation failed on two carriers through an unknown that occurred in no equation, and is kept.

The hypothesis on the pair of walks is the hypothesis of Lemma 3.1(b) of [9] together with a common successor; it holds on the ring and the line. It cannot be dropped. On the countable directed binary tree, with every gain $+1$, each vertex has two successors and distinct vertices have none in common, so $A^*A = 2$; from the root every

walk is the only walk to its end vertex, every event has $\mu_p(S) = |S|$, and every $p > 0$ is consistent with factor 2. This example is due to Director G [3]; it shows that branching together with $A^*A = d$ does not suffice, and it corrects a summary sentence of the first issue of this paper, which named "any branching norm-preserving carrier". Theorem 5.2 is the statement, for the vectors of events, that a unitary matrix which is not a permutation matrix with phases preserves no ℓ_p norm other than the Euclidean one; for all vectors this is the classical description of the isometries of ℓ_p, $p \neq 2$, as permutation matrices with phases, attributed to Li and So in the finite-dimensional case [11]. That reference was not inspected for this paper and is not used in the proof.

5.3 Gains in the roots of unity

Let $q \geq 2$ be even, $\zeta = e^{2\pi i/q}$ and $R = \mathbb{Z}[\zeta]$; a norm-preserving digraph of degree two in which two distinct vertices have a common successor needs -1 among its gains, since two columns with two entries of modulus one are orthogonal only if they share both rows with opposite relative signs; this holds for every finite one [9], and not for the binary tree. So the order is even. For j prime to q let σ_j be the automorphism of R with $\sigma_j(\zeta) = \zeta^j$. It commutes with complex conjugation, $\sigma_{-j} = \overline{\sigma_j}$, and $|\sigma_j(\alpha)|^2 = \sigma_j(|\alpha|^2)$ is a function of $|\alpha|$. Let J contain one of $j, -j$ for each such j; it has $\varphi(q)/2$ elements for $q > 2$, with φ Euler's function, and one for $q = 2$. The character $\sigma_j \circ \chi$ is the conjugate character of [8], Section 8.

Lemma 5.4 (Parallelogram law)**.** *Let Γ be an abelian group and $f \colon \Gamma \to \mathbb{R}$ with $f(x+y) + f(x-y) = 2f(x) + 2f(y)$ for all x, y. Then $B(x,y) = \frac{1}{4}(f(x+y) - f(x-y))$ is symmetric and additive in each argument, and $f(x) = B(x,x)$.*

Proof. The law gives $f(0) = 0$, $f(-y) = f(y)$ and $f(2x) = 4f(x)$, so B is symmetric, $B(0,y) = 0$ and $B(x,x) = f(x)$. Subtracting the law for the pair $(x-y, z)$ from the law for $(x+y, z)$ gives $B(x+z,y) + B(x-z,y) = 2B(x,y)$. With $z = x$ this is $B(2x,y) = 2B(x,y)$; with $x = u+v$, $z = u-v$ it is $B(2u,y) + B(2v,y) = 2B(u+v,y)$, that is, $B(u,y) + B(v,y) = B(u+v,y)$. □

The lemma is the classical characterization of quadratic forms; the proof is included because the group here is a lattice, in which one cannot divide by two.

Theorem 5.5 (Conjugate characters)**.** *Let D be a gain digraph that is norm-preserving of degree two, with χ taking values in the q-th roots of unity, q even. A* block *is a pair of distinct vertices x, x' with a common successor; they then have exactly two common successors y, y'. Suppose that for some block with vertices x, x' and some starting vertex, and for every N, there is a length at which every q-th root of unity is the value of χ on the gains of at least N walks to x and of at least N walks to x'. Then the rule* (5.1) *is consistent under continuation with factor 2 if and only if there are real numbers c_j, $j \in J$, with*

$$\phi(|\alpha|) = \sum_{j \in J} c_j \, |\sigma_j(\alpha)|^2 \qquad \text{for all } \alpha \in R. \tag{5.2}$$

The consistent rules thus form a real vector space of dimension $\varphi(q)/2$ for $q > 2$ and of dimension one for $q = 2$; the rule is unique up to a factor exactly for $q \in \{2, 4, 6\}$.

Proof. The rules (5.2) *are consistent.* For the character $\sigma_j \circ \chi$ the step matrix is $\sigma_j(A)$ and the vector of an event is $\sigma_j(v_S)$. Since σ_j commutes with complex conjugation,

$\sigma_j(A)^*\sigma_j(A) = \sigma_j(A^*A) = 2$, so $\sum_y |\sigma_j(v_S(y))|^2$ is consistent with factor 2 by Lemma 3.1 of [9].

A consistent rule has the form (5.2). Every element of R is a combination of powers of ζ with non-negative integer coefficients, because $-1 = \zeta^{q/2}$. By the hypothesis there is, for any $\alpha, \beta \in R$, an event whose vector has the components α at x and β at x' and no others. With the entries $u_1 = A_{yx}$, $u_2 = A_{yx'}$, $u_3 = A_{y'x}$, $u_4 = A_{y'x'}$ of the block, $\overline{u_1}u_2 + \overline{u_3}u_4 = 0$, and the vector of the continued event has the components $u_1\alpha + u_2\beta$ and $u_3\alpha + u_4\beta$, of moduli $|\alpha + w\beta|$ and $|\alpha - w\beta|$ with $w = \overline{u_1}u_2$ a root of unity in R. Consistency, with $w^{-1}\beta$ in place of β, says that $f(\alpha) = \phi(|\alpha|)$ satisfies the parallelogram law on the additive group of R. By Lemma 5.4, $f(\alpha) = B(\alpha, \alpha)$ with B symmetric and biadditive; B extends to a real symmetric bilinear form on $V = R \otimes \mathbb{R}$, and $B(\zeta\alpha, \zeta\beta) = B(\alpha, \beta)$ because $f(\zeta\alpha) = f(\alpha)$. For $q = 2$, $R = \mathbb{Z}$ and $f(n) = n^2 f(1)$. For $q > 2$ the map $\alpha \mapsto (\sigma_j(\alpha))_{j \in J}$ identifies V with a sum of planes $\mathbb{C}$, on the j-th of which multiplication by ζ is the rotation by $2\pi j/q$. Over the complex numbers this map has the $\varphi(q)$ distinct eigenvalues $\zeta^{\pm j}$, and for eigenvectors v, w with eigenvalues λ, μ invariance gives $B(v, w)(1 - \lambda\mu) = 0$; so B pairs only the two eigenvectors of one plane, and on each plane it is a real multiple c_j of the Euclidean inner product. Hence $f(\alpha) = \sum_j c_j |\sigma_j(\alpha)|^2$.

Dimension. The functions $|\sigma_j(\alpha)|^2$, $j \in J$, are the squared lengths of the components of α in complementary planes and are linearly independent. $\varphi(q)/2 = 1$ for even $q > 2$ exactly when $q \in \{4, 6\}$. □

Example. Let B_q be the gain digraph on two vertices with step matrix $\left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & \zeta \\ 1 & -\zeta \end{smallmatrix}\right)$. It is norm-preserving of degree two. The digraph of pairs (vertex, gain) has two arcs into and out of every pair, a loop at each pair with the first vertex, and is strongly connected, so the numbers of walks to each pair grow without bound for all large lengths and the hypothesis of Theorem 5.5 holds. For $q = 2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12$ a solution of the consistency equations in exact arithmetic in R returns a space of dimension $1, 1, 1, 2, 2, 2$ that contains every function $|\sigma_j(\alpha)|^2$; for $q = 8$ the rule of σ_3 differs from the squared modulus by more than half its value on sampled moduli [2].

Theorem 5.5 says where consistency on histories stops. It forces the second order and then leaves exactly the freedom of Proposition 8.1 of [8]: the choice of the faithful character, that is, of the embedding of the amplitudes in the complex numbers. The orders $2, 4, 6$, for which that proposition makes the measure independent of the character, are the orders for which the consistent rule is unique. For other orders a combination with unequal c_j is a consistent rule that is the squared modulus of no single character. Nothing in the event structure prefers σ_1. An instance on five sheets: for a fixed, independently tagged character, the three-step constructive record has the values $(3 + \sqrt{5})/16$ and $(3 - \sqrt{5})/16$ under two embeddings; from a localized sheet the same record has probability $\frac{1}{4}$ under both (Director G [3, 4]; the two values for the tagged character were recomputed for this paper, and the third is an instance of (5.3) below).

Proposition 5.6 (Positivity and composition)**.** *Let ϕ be of the form* (5.2).

- *(a) $\phi(|\alpha|) \geq 0$ for all $\alpha \in R$ if and only if $c_j \geq 0$ for every $j \in J$.*
- *(b) Suppose the rule is multiplicative on products: for all gain digraphs with gains in the q-th roots of unity, among them one that satisfies the hypothesis of Theorem 5.5, and events S_1, S_2 of the factors, $\mu_\phi(S_1 \times S_2) = \mu_\phi(S_1)\,\mu_\phi(S_2)$, where the product is that of [8], Section 6, with $v_{S_1 \times S_2} = v_{S_1} \otimes v_{S_2}$. Then $\phi = 0$ or there is one $j \in J$ with $\phi(|\alpha|) = |\sigma_j(\alpha)|^2$ for all $\alpha \in R$.*

Proof. (a) If all $c_j \geq 0$ the sum is non-negative. Conversely the image of R in the sum

V of the planes is a lattice of full rank, so the rays through its points are dense in V; if some $c_j < 0$, the form $\sum_j c_j |z_j|^2$ is negative on an open cone of V, which contains a point of the lattice. (b) Put $N_j(\alpha) = |\sigma_j(\alpha)|^2$ and $M_j(S) = \sum_y N_j(v_S(y))$. Since N_j is multiplicative, $\mu_\phi(S_1 \times S_2) = \sum_j c_j M_j(S_1) M_j(S_2)$, while $\mu_\phi(S_1)\mu_\phi(S_2) = \sum_{j,k} c_j c_k M_j(S_1) M_k(S_2)$. On a carrier that satisfies the hypothesis of Theorem 5.5 the events of walks to one vertex have $M_j(S) = N_j(\alpha)$ with α arbitrary in R, and the functions N_j are linearly independent, which means that the vectors $(N_j(\alpha))_{j \in J}$, $\alpha \in R$, span $\mathbb{R}^J$. The events S_1 and S_2 vary independently of each other, so both sides are bilinear forms that agree on a spanning set in each argument, and their coefficients agree: $c_j c_k = \delta_{jk} c_j$ for all j, k. Then every c_j is 0 or 1 and at most one is 1. □

Positivity confines the weights to a cone and selects nothing. Multiplicativity under composition removes the combinations and fixes the normalization: a consistent multiplicative rule is the squared modulus in one conjugate character. Part (b) agrees with a classification obtained independently and issued first by Director G [3]: on the field $\mathbb{Q}(\zeta, \sqrt{2})$, a weight that passes a marginal test with one balanced coin, is invariant under ζ and factorizes on product tables is $\lambda(a\bar{a})$ for a field embedding λ of the real subfield. The hypotheses differ (a marginal condition on records there, consistency on histories here) and the conclusions coincide where both apply. The freedom that remains is the Galois group acting on a single character, the same residue as in Proposition 7.4 of [7] and Proposition 8.1 of [8]; neither consistency nor composition breaks it. Director G describes controls that would: a regular real plane, an order on the real algebraic amplitudes, or a calibrated preparation with a prescribed algebraic entry [3]. Instances of the proposition for $q = 8, 10, 12$ are in [2].

5.4 The signed lift

In Theorem 5.5 the end vertex of a walk is a record and its gain is not. The other reading makes the gain a record. Let $h = q/2$ and $\Lambda = \mathbb{Z}[X]/(X^h + 1)$ with the basis $1, X, \dots, X^{h-1}$; multiplication by X permutes the basis up to the sign $X^h = -1$. For an odd residue j modulo q let $\sigma_j \colon \Lambda \to \mathbb{C}$ be the ring homomorphism with $\sigma_j(X) = \zeta^j$. These are the h characters of the group of q-th roots of unity in which -1 acts as -1; σ_j is faithful exactly when j is prime to q. Let D be a gain digraph with gains ζ^k, $0 \le k < q$, and $\chi(\zeta) = \zeta$. Its *signed lift* $\tilde{D}$ has the vertices (y, s) with $y \in V$ and $s \in \{0, \dots, h-1\}$, the *sheets*, and for every arc of D from x to y with gain ζ^k and every s an arc from (x, s) to (y, t) with gain $\varepsilon = \pm 1$, where $X^{s+k} = \varepsilon X^t$ in Λ. A walk of $\tilde{D}$ from $(x, 0)$ is a walk w of D from x together with the record of its gain $\zeta^{k(w)}$: it ends on the sheet t with gain ε, where $X^{k(w)} = \varepsilon X^t$. For a set S of walks of D of one length from x put

$$\tilde{v}_S(y) = \sum_{w \in S,\ t(w) = y} X^{k(w)} = \sum_{s=0}^{h-1} n_{y,s} X^s \in \Lambda.$$

The integers $n_{y,s}$ are the components of the vector of S on $\tilde{D}$, and $\sigma_j(\tilde{v}_S(y))$ is the component at y of its vector on D for the character $\zeta \mapsto \zeta^j$.

Corollary 5.7 (Signed lift)**.** *Let D be a finite gain digraph that is norm-preserving of degree two, with gains in the q-th roots of unity, q even.*

(a) $\tilde{D}$ has gains ± 1 and is norm-preserving of degree two.

(b) On each connected component of $\tilde{D}$ the rule (5.1)*, with the pairs of a vertex and a sheet as end vertices and $\phi(1) \neq 0$, is consistent under continuation with a factor $c > 0$ if and only if $c = 2$ and $\phi(n) = n^2 \phi(1)$ for every integer $n \ge 0$.*

(c) With $\phi(1)=1$ the value of that rule on a set S of walks of D of one length from one vertex is the integer

$$\tilde{\mu}(S)=\sum_{y\in V}\sum_{s=0}^{h-1}n_{y,s}^2=\frac{2}{q}\sum_{j\ \mathrm{odd}}\sum_{y\in V}\bigl|\sigma_j(\tilde{v}_S(y))\bigr|^2, \tag{5.3}$$

the mean, with equal weights, of the squared-modulus rules of the h characters σ_j, faithful or not.

(d) For $q\geq 6$ and every odd j the function $|\sigma_j(\cdot)|^2$ on Λ is not a sum over the sheets of a function of $|n_s|$.

Proof. (a) Every column of the step matrix $\tilde{A}$ of $\tilde{D}$ has two entries ±1. In a block of D with vertices x,x', successors y,y' and entries $u_i=\zeta^{k_i}$ as in the proof of Theorem 5.5, the relation $\overline{u_1}u_2+\overline{u_3}u_4=0$ reads $k_2-k_1\equiv k_4-k_3+h$ modulo q. The columns (x,s) and (x',s') of $\tilde{A}$ have a common row over y exactly when $s+k_1\equiv s'+k_2$ modulo h, and over y' exactly when $s+k_3\equiv s'+k_4$ modulo h; by the relation the two conditions are the same. When they hold, the products of the two entries in the common rows are the signs $X^{(s'+k_2)-(s+k_1)}$ and $X^{(s'+k_4)-(s+k_3)}$, and their quotient is $X^{(k_2-k_1)-(k_4-k_3)}=-1$, an odd power of X^h. So the two columns are orthogonal. Columns over vertices of different blocks have disjoint supports, and two columns over one vertex of D on different sheets also. Hence $\tilde{A}^{\mathsf{T}}\tilde{A}=2$. (b) A connected component of $\tilde{D}$ is closed under successors and predecessors, so it is a finite gain digraph with gains ±1, norm-preserving of degree two, with connected underlying graph, and Theorem 5.3 applies. (c) The first equality is the description of the walks of $\tilde{D}$ given above. For $0\leq s,s'<h$ the sum of $\zeta^{j(s-s')}$ over the odd residues j is h if $s=s'$ and 0 otherwise, so $\sum_{j\ \mathrm{odd}}|\sigma_j(\sum_s n_sX^s)|^2=h\sum_s n_s^2$. (d) The elements $1+X$ and $1+X^2$ have the same absolute values of coordinates up to their order, and $|\sigma_j(1+X)|^2=2+2\cos(2\pi j/q)$ differs from $|\sigma_j(1+X^2)|^2=2+2\cos(4\pi j/q)$: equality would need q to divide j or $3j$, which an even q does not for odd j. For $q=4$ the element $1+X^2$ is zero and the statement fails: there $|\sigma_1(\cdot)|^2$ is the sum of the squares of the two sheet coordinates. □

With the sheets as records nothing is left to select. On each connected component the rule is unique up to a factor for every even order; when the lift has several components the factors of different components are independent, and (c) takes them equal. Part (c) is stated for walks lifted from the sheet 0; multiplication by X carries it to any other sheet. With that normalization the rule is unique, its values are integers, and no embedding of the amplitudes enters; for $q=2$ and $q=4$ it is the rule of Theorem 5.5, and for $q\geq 6$ it is none of the single-character rules. Its value (5.3) is the mean of the conjugate rules together with those of the characters that are not faithful; for $q=10$ the residue 5, in which ζ acts as -1, carries one fifth of the weight. Proposition 4.4 of [8] identifies the coincidence count on the covering graph with the dimension-weighted mean over the characters; Corollary 5.7 adds that on the signed lift this mean is the only consistent rule of the record-sum form. The freedom of Theorem 5.5 therefore belongs to the reduction by a character, in which the end vertex of D is a record and the sheet is not. An event from one vertex of $\tilde{D}$ has an integer vector and enters every character with the weight fixed by (5.3); multiplication by X is an orthogonal map on the vectors of $\tilde{D}$ that commutes with the step and not with the sheet records, and the characters σ_j are its sectors.

Director G obtained first, for the signed walk with a sheet coordinate and odd h, that every protocol of steps and coordinate records from a localized sheet has the same rational law $2^{-t}\sum_i m_i^2$ under each of the embedding laws of [3], and that an integer branch vector is not supported in a single faithful plane when $\varphi(h)>2$ [4].

Corollary 5.7(b) and (c) reach the same law from the event structure, without assuming that the rule is one of the embedding laws; the assumption used instead is the record-sum form with the sheets as records. The instance of Section 5 on five sheets shows both readings: $\frac{1}{4}$ is the mean of $(3+\sqrt{5})/16$ and $(3-\sqrt{5})/16$, each with weight $\frac{2}{5}$, and of $\frac{1}{2}$ with weight $\frac{1}{5}$. Which reading applies, that is, whether the gain of a walk is recorded at its end, is an assumption about records and is not decided here. Records of the sheet modulo a divisor of h are not treated. Instances of the corollary for $q = 4, 6, 8, 10, 12$, with the lifts of B_q and of 25 random carriers, are in [2].

5.5 Pair rules with a kernel

The two preceding subsections fix what is recorded and classify the rules of the form (5.1). The pair rules of [8] need no such choice. By Theorem 4.1 of [8] a pair rule that is unchanged by switching is given by a class function on the group. Let C be a finite abelian group, written multiplicatively, and f a real function on C with $f(g^{-1}) = f(g)$, the *kernel*; put

$$\mu_f(S) = \sum_{\substack{w,w' \in S \\ t(w)=t(w')}} f(\varphi(w')\varphi(w)^{-1}). \tag{5.4}$$

For a character χ of C let v_S^χ be the vector of S and A_χ the step matrix. The kernel $\operatorname{Re}\chi$ gives $\mu_f(S) = \|v_S^\chi\|^2$. For a gain digraph D in which every vertex has d successors let

$$X(D) = \{\chi : A_\chi^* A_\chi = d\}$$

be the set of characters for which D is norm-preserving of degree d. It is closed under complex conjugation and under the automorphisms of the field generated by the values of the characters, since the entries of $A_\chi^* A_\chi$ are sums of values of χ.

Theorem 5.8 (Kernel rules)**.** *Let C be a finite abelian group and D a gain digraph with gains in C in which every vertex has d successors.*

(i) If f is a real combination of the functions $\operatorname{Re}\chi$*, $\chi \in X(D)$, then μ_f is consistent under continuation with factor d.*

(ii) Suppose that for every two distinct vertices y_1, y_2 with a common successor there is a starting vertex such that the quotients $\varphi(w_2)\varphi(w_1)^{-1}$, for walks w_1 to y_1 and w_2 to y_2 of one common length, take every value in C. If μ_f is not identically zero and is consistent under continuation with a factor $c > 0$, then $c = d$ and f is a real combination of the functions $\operatorname{Re}\chi$*, $\chi \in X(D)$.*

Proof. (i) Then $\mu_f(S) = \sum_\chi a_\chi \|v_S^\chi\|^2$ over $\chi \in X(D)$, and each term is consistent with factor d by Lemma 3.1 of [9].

(ii) Write $f = \sum_\chi c_\chi \chi$ over all characters, with real $c_\chi = c_{\bar\chi}$. A single walk has $\mu_f = f(1)$, and its d continuations end at different vertices, so $d\,f(1) = c\,f(1)$. Let $y_1 \neq y_2$ have the set $Z \neq \emptyset$ of common successors, let w_1, w_2 be walks of one length to y_1, y_2 with quotient g, and $S = \{w_1, w_2\}$, so $\mu_f(S) = 2f(1)$. Among the $2d$ walks of $\operatorname{Ext} S$ the pairs with a common end vertex are each walk with itself and, for $z \in Z$, the continuations of w_1 and w_2 to z, with quotient $g\,r_z$, $r_z = u_{zy_2}u_{zy_1}^{-1}$, where u_{zy} is the gain of the arc from y to z. Each such pair is counted in both orders, so

$$\mu_f(\operatorname{Ext} S) = 2d\,f(1) + 2\sum_{z\in Z} f(g\,r_z) = 2d\,f(1) + 2\sum_\chi c_\chi\,\rho_\chi\,\chi(g), \qquad \rho_\chi = \sum_{z\in Z}\chi(r_z) = (A_\chi^* A_\chi)_{y_1 y_2}.$$

Consistency says that $\sum_\chi c_\chi \rho_\chi \chi(g) = (c-d)f(1)$ for every $g \in C$. The characters are linearly independent functions on C, so $c_\chi \rho_\chi = 0$ for every character other than the

trivial one, and $c_1|Z| = (c-d)f(1)$ for the trivial one. If $f(1) \neq 0$, then $c = d$ and $c_1 = 0$. If $f(1) = 0$, again $c_1 = 0$. In both cases $c_\chi (A_\chi^* A_\chi)_{y_1 y_2} = 0$ for every χ and every such pair of vertices. The diagonal entries of $A_\chi^* A_\chi$ are d and its entries for two vertices without a common successor are zero; so $c_\chi \neq 0$ implies $\chi \in X(D)$, and f is a combination of the $\operatorname{Re}\chi$ with $\chi \in X(D)$. By (i) μ_f then multiplies by d under continuation, and since it is not identically zero, $c = d$. If no two distinct vertices have a common successor, every character is in $X(D)$, two different walks from one vertex never end at one vertex, $\mu_f(S) = |S| f(1)$, and $c = d$. □

Within the pair rules the theorem leaves no freedom except the one it names: the consistent rules are the mixtures of the squared-norm rules of the characters for which the step is norm-preserving. On a tree every character qualifies and every kernel is consistent, which is the example of Director G after Theorem 5.2. Without the hypothesis on the quotients more kernels are consistent.

Corollary 5.9 (Degree two)**.** *Let C be a finite abelian group, $\epsilon \in C$ of order two, and D a gain digraph with gains in C whose vertices have two successors and two predecessors and fall into blocks, as in Theorem 4.3 of [9]: pairs $\{x, x'\}$ with a common pair of successors $\{y, y'\}$, the pairs of successors of different blocks being disjoint, with $u_4 u_3^{-1} = \epsilon\, u_2 u_1^{-1}$ in every block. Then $X(D)$ is the set of characters with $\chi(\epsilon) = -1$, and under the hypothesis of Theorem 5.8(ii) a kernel f with μ_f not identically zero is consistent if and only if $f(\epsilon g) = -f(g)$ for all $g \in C$. For C the group of the q-th roots of unity, $\epsilon = -1$ and D norm-preserving of degree two for the faithful character:*

- *(a) the consistent kernels are the combinations of* $\operatorname{Re}\chi_j$, $\chi_j(\zeta) = \zeta^j$, j *odd, one from each pair* $\pm j$*, a space of dimension* $\lceil q/4 \rceil$*;*
- *(b) the rules of Theorem 5.5 are those with coefficient zero unless j is prime to q;*
- *(c) the rule of Corollary 5.7 is the kernel with $f(1) = 1$, $f(-1) = -1$ and $f = 0$ elsewhere, that is, $f = \frac{2}{q} \sum_{j \text{ odd}} \chi_j$;*
- *(d) on a carrier that satisfies the hypothesis of Theorem 5.5, a consistent rule* (5.4) *that is multiplicative on products, where gains are multiplied in C as in Proposition 5.6, is zero or $\|v_S^{(j)}\|^2$ for one odd j, which need not be prime to q.*

Proof. The entry of $A_\chi^* A_\chi$ for the two vertices of a block is $\chi(u_2 u_1^{-1})(1 + \chi(\epsilon))$, which vanishes exactly when $\chi(\epsilon) = -1$; the other entries off the diagonal are zero, because vertices of different blocks have no common successor. A kernel is a combination of characters with $\chi(\epsilon) = -1$ exactly when $f(\epsilon g) = -f(g)$: the coefficient of χ in f is $|C|^{-1} \sum_g f(g)\overline{\chi(g)}$, in which the terms of g and ϵg cancel if $f(\epsilon g) = -f(g)$ and $\chi(\epsilon) = 1$; conversely every character with $\chi(\epsilon) = -1$ has this symmetry. For the cyclic group the faithful character turns norm-preservation into the relation $u_4 u_3^{-1} = -u_2 u_1^{-1}$ in C. (a) With $h = q/2$, $f(\zeta^{h-k}) = -f(\zeta^k)$, so f is determined by its values at ζ^k, $0 \leq k < h/2$, which are free. (b) is the definition of those rules. (c) follows from (5.3). (d) is the argument of Proposition 5.6(b): the functions $\|v_S^{(j)}\|^2$, j odd, on events of walks to one vertex are the squared lengths of the components of an arbitrary element of Λ in complementary subspaces of $\Lambda \otimes \mathbb{R}$ and are linearly independent. □

In degree two, then, the kernel has to see the central element ϵ as a sign and is otherwise free. Consistency on histories excludes every character in which ϵ acts trivially, the constant kernel of the coincidence count on D among them, and admits every mixture of the others. For the roots of unity the rule is unique up to a factor only for $q = 2$ and $q = 4$; for $q = 6$ there are two, the faithful one and the sign character, in which the cube roots of unity are not seen. Theorem 5.5 and Corollary 5.7 are two

sections of this family: the first by the requirement that the rule be a function of the faithful amplitude, the second by the requirement that it be a sum over sheets. Strong positivity in the sense of [8] is non-negativity of the coefficients (Theorem 4.1(b) of [8]). By (d), composition leaves one character with $\chi(-1) = -1$ and does not make it faithful: that the whole group of gains acts is an assumption of Proposition 5.6, contained in the form (5.1) with the faithful character, and is not a consequence of consistency or composition.

Three instances outside the cyclic case of degree two. For two sheet registers of prime order and a sign, the carrier of Director G's relative transport [5], the group is not cyclic and has no faithful character; the corollary applies with ϵ the sign, and the consistent kernels are those odd under it. In degree three, with the block of gains ω^{zy} of [9], $X(D)$ consists of the characters that are not trivial on ω; if the gains lie in the sixth roots of unity, the characters of order three belong to it and the character of order two does not, so that -1 acting as -1 is a feature of degree two and not of consistency. In degree four with the block i^{zy} and gains in the eighth roots of unity, $X(D)$ is again the set of odd characters. Computed solution spaces agree with $X(D)$ on 47 carriers that satisfy the hypothesis, in these families and in the cyclic case of degree two, and are larger on carriers that do not [2]. Two predicates that required a minimum number of carriers with the hypothesis failed, in the first run for the two-register family and again in a follow-up with twelve small carriers, of which one qualified; they are kept, together with the three failed predicates of the first computation for the cyclic case, which did not test the hypothesis and used a threshold without basis. A reader working without the author's notes examined the theorem and the corollary step by step and compared solution spaces with $X(D)$ on about 2500 carriers by a program of its own; it found no counterexample and four omissions in the wording of the corollary, which are corrected here. The recursion of Theorem 5.1 and Lemma 5.4 for integer values have been checked in Lean 4 [2].

5.6 The record-sum form in degrees three and four

Theorem 5.2 excludes every power other than the second on any norm-preserving carrier with merging walks, and Theorems 5.3 and 5.5 treat a general function of the modulus in degree two. For two blocks of higher degree the same conclusion holds.

Proposition 5.10 (Blocks of degree three and four)**.** *Let $d \in \{3, 4\}$, $w = e^{2\pi i/d}$, and let D be a gain digraph in which every vertex has d successors and the vertices fall into blocks: d vertices $x_0, \dots, x_{d-1}$ with the common successors $y_0, \dots, y_{d-1}$ and gains $\rho_z \kappa_y w^{zy}$ on the arc from x_y to y_z, with ρ_z, κ_y and all gains in the q-th roots of unity, $q \in \{3, 6\}$ for $d = 3$ and $q = 4$ for $d = 4$, the sets of successors of different blocks being disjoint. Suppose that for some block and some starting vertex, and for every N, there is a length at which every q-th root of unity is the gain of at least N walks to each vertex of the block. Then the rule* (5.1) *is consistent under continuation with factor d if and only if $\phi(|\alpha|) = c\,|\alpha|^2$ for all $\alpha \in \mathbb{Z}[\zeta]$, with a real constant c.*

Proof. The columns of a block are orthogonal and columns of different blocks have disjoint supports, so $A^*A = d$ and the square is consistent by Lemma 3.1 of [9]. Conversely, by the hypothesis there is for any $\beta_0, \dots, \beta_{d-1} \in R = \mathbb{Z}[\zeta]$ an event whose vector has the components $\kappa_y^{-1}\beta_y$ at x_y and no others; the vector of the continued event has the moduli $|\sum_y w^{zy}\beta_y|$, $z = 0, \dots, d-1$. Put $f(\alpha) = \phi(|\alpha|)$; it satisfies $f(\zeta\alpha) = f(\alpha)$, and $f(-\alpha) = f(\alpha)$.

For $d = 4$ take $(\beta_y) = (a, 0, b, 0)$. The moduli are $|a+b|, |a-b|, |a+b|, |a-b|$, and consistency reads $2f(a+b) + 2f(a-b) = 4f(a) + 4f(b)$, the parallelogram law on R.

For $d = 3$ take $(\beta_y) = (a, b, b)$. Since $w + w^2 = -1$ the moduli are $|a + 2b|, |a - b|, |a - b|$, and consistency reads

$$f(a + 2b) + 2f(a - b) = 3f(a) + 6f(b) \qquad \text{for all } a, b \in R.$$

This equation for the pair $(a+b, -b)$ is $f(a-b)+2f(a+2b) = 3f(a+b)+6f(b)$. Eliminating $f(a + 2b)$ between the two gives $f(a + b) + f(a - b) = 2f(a) + 2f(b)$.

In both cases Lemma 5.4 gives $f(\alpha) = B(\alpha, \alpha)$ with B symmetric, biadditive and invariant under multiplication by ζ. For $q \in \{3, 4, 6\}$ the space $R \otimes \mathbb{R}$ is one plane on which ζ acts as a rotation of order $q \geq 3$, and an invariant symmetric form on it is a multiple of the Euclidean one, as in the proof of Theorem 5.5. □

The elimination for $d = 3$ has been checked in Lean 4 on an arbitrary abelian group, for integer values with the core library and for real values with Mathlib; the evenness of f also follows from the displayed equation alone. With Mathlib the following are checked as well, for real values: Lemma 5.4, including additivity of B and $B(nx, y) = nB(x, y)$ for integers n; the recursion of Theorem 5.1; and the step of Theorem 5.8 that a combination of characters which is constant on the group has no nontrivial character [2]. The graph-theoretic parts of these theorems are not formalized. On eleven carriers of these two kinds a solution of the consistency equations over sampled events, with the squared moduli computed as integer norms up to 25, returns a one-dimensional space proportional to the norm [2]. Other blocks, other degrees and gains of higher order are not treated; for gains of higher order in these degrees the conjugate characters will enter as in Theorem 5.5.

The proposition is the case of two small degrees and small orders of a statement that holds for every degree.

Theorem 5.11 (Fourier blocks of any degree)**.** *Let $d \geq 2$ divide q, $\zeta = e^{2\pi i/q}$, $w = \zeta^{q/d}$, $R = \mathbb{Z}[\zeta]$, and let D be a gain digraph in which every vertex has d successors and the vertices fall into blocks: d vertices $x_0, \dots, x_{d-1}$ with the common successors $y_0, \dots, y_{d-1}$ and the gain $\rho_z \kappa_y w^{zy}$ on the arc from x_y to y_z, with ρ_z, κ_y q-th roots of unity, the sets of successors of different blocks being disjoint. Suppose that for some block and some starting vertex, and for every N, there is a length at which every q-th root of unity is the gain of at least N walks to each vertex of the block. Then the rule* (5.1) *is consistent under continuation with factor d if and only if it has the form* (5.2)*: $\phi(|\alpha|) = \sum_{j \in J} c_j |\sigma_j(\alpha)|^2$ for all $\alpha \in R$, with real c_j. The consistent rules form a space of dimension $\varphi(q)/2$ for $q > 2$ and of dimension one for $q = 2$. Here q may be odd; σ_j, J and* (5.2) *are defined as for even q.*

Proof. The rules (5.2) *are consistent.* For j prime to q, $\sigma_j(w)$ is a primitive d-th root of unity, so the columns of a block of $\sigma_j(A)$ are orthogonal: $\sum_z \sigma_j(w)^{z(y-y')} = 0$ for $y \neq y'$. Columns of different blocks have disjoint supports. Hence $\sigma_j(A)^* \sigma_j(A) = d$ and Lemma 3.1 of [9] applies.

The parallelogram law. As in the proof of Proposition 5.10 there is for any $\beta_0, \dots, \beta_{d-1} \in R$ an event whose continuation has the moduli $|\sum_y w^{zy} \beta_y|$, and $f(\alpha) = \phi(|\alpha|)$ satisfies $f(-\alpha) = f(\alpha) = f(\zeta\alpha)$ and $f(0) = 0$. If d is even, (β_y) with $\beta_0 = a$, $\beta_{d/2} = b$ and the others zero gives the moduli $|a + b|$ and $|a - b|$, each $d/2$ times, and consistency is the parallelogram law. Let d be odd, $d \geq 3$, and $k = d - 2$. Take $(\beta_y) = (a, b, \dots, b)$. Since $\sum_{y \geq 1} w^{zy} = -1$ for $z \neq 0$, the moduli are $|a + (d-1)b|$ once and $|a - b|$ $d - 1$ times:

$$f(a + (d-1)b) + (d-1)f(a - b) = d\, f(a) + d(d-1)f(b).$$

The same equation for the pair $(a+kb,-b)$ is $f(a-b)+(d-1)f(a+(d-1)b)=d\,f(a+kb)+d(d-1)f(b)$. Eliminating $f(a+(d-1)b)$ and dividing by d gives

$$k\,f(a-b)+f(a+kb)=(k+1)f(a)+k(k+1)f(b) \qquad \text{for all } a,b\in R. \tag{5.5}$$

Write $M(a,b)$ for the difference of the two sides of (5.5). Then

$$(k+1)\,M(a,b)-k\,M(a+b,b)+M(a+kb,-b)=k(k+1)\big(f(a+b)+f(a-b)-2f(a)-f(b)-f(-b)\big),$$

because the terms $f(a+kb)$ and $f(a+(k+1)b)$ cancel and the coefficient of $f(a)$ is $(k+1)^2+k^2-1=2k(k+1)$. The left side is zero and $f(-b)=f(b)$, since f depends on the modulus only, so $f(a+b)+f(a-b)=2f(a)+2f(b)$. This combination was found in the course of a formal proof; the statement that (5.5) implies the parallelogram law for every $k\geq 1$, without assuming that f is even, is checked in Lean 4 with Mathlib [2].

Conclusion. By Lemma 5.4, $f(\alpha)=B(\alpha,\alpha)$ with B symmetric, biadditive and invariant under multiplication by ζ, and the last part of the proof of Theorem 5.5 applies without change. For odd q the only point to add is that every element of R is still a combination of powers of ζ with non-negative integer coefficients, because $-1=\zeta+\zeta^2+\cdots+\zeta^{q-1}$; this is what the hypothesis needs in order to realize arbitrary β_y. □

For $d=2$ the block is that of Theorem 5.5 up to the factors ρ,κ. Thus on these carriers the degree plays no part: a consistent rule of the record-sum form is of the second order, and what remains free is the combination of conjugate characters, unique exactly for $q\in\{2,3,4,6\}$. On 33 carriers with $d=3,4,5,6$ and q up to 12 that satisfy the hypothesis the computed solution spaces have dimension $\varphi(q)/2$ and contain the conjugate rules; in a first run two carriers whose gains generate a proper subgroup had smaller spaces, and the two predicates that did not test the hypothesis failed and are kept [2]. The disjointness of the successor sets cannot be dropped: on four vertices with the blocks $\{0,1\}\to\{0,2\}$ and $\{2,3\}\to\{1,2\}$ and signs of the form required, $A^{*}A\neq 2$ and no rule other than zero is consistent. This example, and the omission of the condition from the first issue of Proposition 5.10, were found by a challenger working from the text of the paper alone. Blocks that are not of this form, such as real Hadamard blocks of degree four with other sign patterns or blocks from other groups, are not treated.

5.7 Any norm-preserving carrier with a merging pair

The form of the blocks is not needed. One pair of vertices with a common successor suffices, on a norm-preserving carrier of any degree with gains in the roots of unity, provided the events at that pair are rich enough.

Theorem 5.12 (Vanishing sums)**.** *Let $q\geq 2$, $\zeta=e^{2\pi i/q}$, $R=\mathbb{Z}[\zeta]$, and let $f\colon R\to\mathbb{R}$ depend only on $|\alpha|$. Let $u_1,\dots,u_m$, $m\geq 2$, be roots of unity in R with $u_1+\cdots+u_m=0$, and suppose*

$$\sum_{z=1}^{m} f(a+u_z b)=m\,f(a)+m\,f(b) \qquad \textit{for all } a,b\in R. \tag{5.6}$$

Then $f(\alpha)=\sum_{j\in J}c_j|\sigma_j(\alpha)|^2$ with real c_j; for $q=2$, $f(n)=n^2f(1)$. Conversely every such f satisfies (5.6)*. Here q may be odd, with σ_j and J defined as for even q, and the u_z may be any roots of unity of R, for odd q also the negatives of the q-th roots.*

Proof. Put $n = \varphi(q)$ and $V = R \otimes \mathbb{R}$, identified with $\mathbb{C}^{n/2}$ by $x = (\sigma_j)_{j \in J}$ for $q > 2$; multiplication in R is componentwise multiplication in V. For $q = 2$, $R = \mathbb{Z}$, the u_z are $m/2$ times 1 and $m/2$ times -1, (5.6) is the parallelogram law, and the claim follows as in Theorem 5.1. Let $q > 2$.

Step 1: f is a polynomial. For $h \in R$ let X^h be the shift $(X^h f)(a) = f(a + h)$; the shifts span the group ring $\mathbb{C}[R]$, a ring of Laurent polynomials in n variables. For fixed $b = \xi$ the difference of the two sides of (5.6) is the function $(\sum_z X^{\xi u_z} - m) f$ minus a constant, so

$$g_{h,\xi} = (X^h - 1)\Big(\sum_z X^{\xi u_z} - m\Big)$$

annihilates f for all $h, \xi \in R$. A common zero of all $g_{h,\xi}$ is a homomorphism $\chi \colon R \to \mathbb{C}^*$. If $\chi \neq 1$, take h with $\chi(h) \neq 1$; then $\sum_z \chi(\xi u_z) = m$ for every ξ. Replacing ξ by $k\xi$, $k = 1, \dots, m$, the numbers $w_z = \chi(\xi u_z)$ have the power sums of $(1, \dots, 1)$, so $w_z = 1$ for all z by Newton's identities. Then $\chi(\xi u_1) = 1$ for all ξ, and u_1 is a unit, so $\chi = 1$, a contradiction. The ideal generated by the $g_{h,\xi}$ therefore has the single zero $\chi = 1$; by the Nullstellensatz it contains a power $\mathfrak{a}^K$ of the augmentation ideal $\mathfrak{a}$, which is generated by the $X^h - 1$. So every K-fold difference of f vanishes, and f is the restriction to R of a real polynomial P on V.

Step 2: P is a polynomial in the $t_j = |x_j|^2$. For $\beta, c \in R$, $|\beta c| = |\bar\beta c|$, so $P(\beta c) = P(\bar\beta c)$ on $R \times R$, hence on $V \times V$, because a lattice of full rank is Zariski dense. With $\beta = (e^{i\theta_j})_j$ and $e^{i\theta} c$ in place of c this is $P(e^{2i\theta} c) = P(c)$: P is invariant under the torus, and the invariant polynomials are those in the t_j.

Step 3: P is linear in the t_j. Equation (5.6) is now a polynomial identity on $V \times V$, in which u_z acts on the j-th coordinate as $\sigma_j(u_z)$. Let P_d be the homogeneous part of degree $d \geq 4$ in the real coordinates. The part of (5.6) of degree $d-2$ in a and 2 in b has no term on the right. On the left it is $\frac{1}{2} \sum_z D^2 P_d(a)[u_z b, u_z b]$, in which the monomial $b_j \bar b_j$ has the coefficient $\sum_z |\sigma_j(u_z)|^2 \, \partial_{x_j} \partial_{\bar x_j} P_d = m \, \partial_{x_j} \partial_{\bar x_j} P_d$. So $\partial_{x_j} \partial_{\bar x_j} P_d = 0$ for every j. For $P_d = g(t)$ this reads $\partial_{t_j}(t_j \, \partial_{t_j} g) = 0$, so $t_j \partial_{t_j} g$ does not depend on t_j and, being divisible by t_j, is zero. Hence g is constant, and $P_d = 0$. There are no parts of odd degree, and $P(0) = 0$ by (5.6) at $a = b = 0$. So $P = \sum_j c_j t_j$.

Converse. $\sum_z |\sigma_j(a + u_z b)|^2 = m|\sigma_j(a)|^2 + m|\sigma_j(b)|^2 + 2 \operatorname{Re}(\overline{\sigma_j(a)} \sigma_j(b) \, \sigma_j(\sum_z u_z))$, and the last term is zero. □

Corollary 5.13 (Carriers with a merging pair)**.** *Let D be a gain digraph with χ taking values in the q-th roots of unity and $A^*A = d$. Let $y_1 \neq y_2$ be vertices with a common successor, and suppose that for some starting vertex and every N there is a length at which every q-th root of unity is the value of χ on the gains of at least N walks to y_1 and of at least N walks to y_2. Then the rule* (5.1) *with $\phi(1) \neq 0$ is consistent under continuation with a factor $c > 0$ if and only if $c = d$ and it has the form* (5.2)*.*

Proof. The rules (5.2) are consistent with factor d because $\sigma_j(A)^* \sigma_j(A) = \sigma_j(A^*A) = d$. Conversely, a single walk has measure $\phi(1)$ and its d continuations end at different vertices, so $c = d$. Let Z be the set of the m common successors of y_1, y_2. For $a, b \in R$ there is an event with the components a at y_1 and b at y_2 and no others. Its continuation has the modulus $|a|$ at the $d - m$ other successors of y_1, $|b|$ at those of y_2, and $|aA_{zy_1} + bA_{zy_2}| = |a + u_z b|$ at $z \in Z$, with $u_z = \overline{A_{zy_1}} A_{zy_2}$ and $\sum_z u_z = 0$ by the orthogonality of the two columns; so $m \geq 2$. Consistency is (5.6) for $f(\alpha) = \phi(|\alpha|)$, and Theorem 5.12 applies. □

Where its hypothesis holds, Corollary 5.13 gives the conclusions of Theorems 5.1, 5.3, 5.5 and 5.11 and of Proposition 5.10, and extends Theorem 5.2 from powers to

arbitrary functions of the modulus: on a norm-preserving carrier with gains in the roots of unity, of any degree and with blocks of any form, in which two vertices have a common successor and every gain reaches both in abundance, a consistent rule of the record-sum form is of the second order, and its only freedom is the combination of conjugate characters. It does not replace those theorems. Theorem 5.3 needs no abundance of gains, which it obtains from finiteness and connectedness, and Theorem 5.2 needs neither abundance nor roots of unity; whether the corollary's hypothesis follows from theirs is not examined. The earlier proofs are kept because they are elementary and give the parallelogram law by explicit instances; the present one uses the Nullstellensatz and gives no bound on K. The hypothesis that f depends on the modulus cannot be weakened to invariance under units, signs and conjugation: $f(a) = \mathrm{Re}(a^4)$ on $\mathbb{Z}[i]$ has these invariances and satisfies (5.6) for $(u_z) = (1, i, -1, -i)$, and is not a function of $|a|$ ($f(5) = 625$, $f(3+4i) = -527$). The theorem, the example and a number of explicit certificates for special (u_z) were found with a sub-agent; exact solutions of (5.6) on boxes of R for $q = 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 10, 12$ and 21 vanishing multisets have dimension $\varphi(q)/2$ once the box is large enough, and three runs on boxes that were too small failed and are kept [2].

5.8 When the gains are abundant

The hypothesis of Corollary 5.13 on the abundance of gains can be decided from the carrier. Let D be finite with gains in a finite abelian group C, and let $\hat{D}$ be the digraph on $V \times C$ with an arc from (x, g) to $(y, g\varphi(e))$ for every arc e from x to y; a walk of D from x with gain g is a walk of $\hat{D}$ from $(x, 1)$ to $(t(w), g)$. The period of a strongly connected digraph is the greatest common divisor of the lengths of its closed walks.

Proposition 5.14 (Abundance)**.** *Let D be a finite gain digraph with gains in a finite abelian group C and $A^*A = d$, $d \geq 2$, for some character, and let $\hat{D}$ be strongly connected, with period r; let r_0 be the period of D.*

- *(a) Every vertex of D has d successors and d predecessors. r_0 divides r, and there is a homomorphism $\pi\colon C \to \mathbb{Z}/r$ with image $r_0\mathbb{Z}/r$ such that (x, gh) lies $\pi(h)$ cyclic classes of $\hat{D}$ after (x, g). Put $C_0 = \ker \pi$; its index is r/r_0.*
- *(b) Let $y_1 \neq y_2$ have a common successor z, and $u = \varphi(y_1 \to z)\,\varphi(y_2 \to z)^{-1}$. For every starting vertex, every coset K of C_0 and every N there is a length at which the gains of the walks to y_1 are exactly the elements of K, each at least N times, and those of the walks to y_2 exactly the elements of Ku, each at least N times. At no length do gains of two cosets occur at one vertex.*
- *(c) Every element of C is the gain of walks of one common length to y_1, and likewise to y_2, if and only if $r = r_0$; in particular if $\hat{D}$ is aperiodic. For a faithful character this is the hypothesis of Corollary 5.13; for a character that is not faithful that hypothesis, which concerns the values of the character, can hold although $r \neq r_0$.*

Proof. (a) D is strongly connected, being the image of $\hat{D}$, so r_0 is defined; a closed walk of $\hat{D}$ projects to a closed walk of D of the same length, so r_0 divides r. $A/\sqrt{d}$ is a square matrix with orthonormal columns, hence unitary, so the rows of A have squared length d as well: every vertex has d predecessors. The same holds in $\hat{D}$. The group C acts on $\hat{D}$ by the automorphisms $(x, g) \mapsto (x, gh)$, which permute the r cyclic classes cyclically by a shift $\pi(h)$ that does not depend on the vertex, because an automorphism maps walks to walks; π is a homomorphism. A closed walk of D at x of length ℓ with gain h is a walk of $\hat{D}$ from $(x, 1)$ to (x, h), so $\pi(h) \equiv \ell$ modulo r; the lengths of closed walks generate $r_0\mathbb{Z}$ and their gains generate C, since $\hat{D}$ is strongly connected. Hence the image of π is $r_0\mathbb{Z}/r$.

(b) (y_1, g) and (y_2, gu) have the common successor $(z, g\varphi(y_1 \to z))$, so they lie in one cyclic class. The vertices over y_1 in the class of (y_1, g) are the (y_1, gh) with $h \in C_0$. The r-th power of the arc-count matrix of $\hat{D}$ is primitive on each cyclic class, so for large L in the right residue class modulo r every vertex of the class of (y_1, g) is reached from $(x_0, 1)$ by walks of length L, and by none of another class; since every vertex has $d \geq 2$ predecessors the numbers of walks grow without bound.

(c) By (b) all gains occur at y_1 at one length exactly when $C_0 = C$. □

Corollary 5.15. *Under the hypotheses of Proposition 5.14, with C the q-th roots of unity and the faithful character, let $y_1 \neq y_2$ have a common successor and let q_0 be the order of C_0. Then $q_0 \geq 2$, the amplitudes at one vertex of all events of one length from one starting vertex lie in $g\,\mathbb{Z}[C_0]$ for some $g \in C$, and the rule* (5.1) *with $\phi(1) \neq 0$ is consistent under continuation with a factor $c > 0$ if and only if $c = d$ and $\phi(|\alpha|) = \sum_j c_j |\sigma_j(\alpha)|^2$ for $\alpha \in \mathbb{Z}[C_0]$, the sum over the conjugate characters of the q_0-th roots of unity. The space of consistent rules, as functions on the moduli that occur, has dimension $\varphi(q_0)/2$ for $q_0 > 2$ and one for $q_0 = 2$.*

Proof. For a second common successor z' the vertices $(z', g\varphi(y_1 \to z'))$ and $(z', gu\varphi(y_2 \to z'))$ lie in one class, so $u\,u_{z'} \in C_0$ with $u_{z'} = \overline{A_{z'y_1}} A_{z'y_2}$; the $u\,u_{z'}$ sum to zero, so $C_0 \neq 1$. By Proposition 5.14(b), for $a', b' \in \mathbb{Z}[C_0]$ there is an event with the components ga' at y_1 and gub' at y_2 and no others: every element of $\mathbb{Z}[C_0]$ is a combination of elements of C_0 with non-negative integer coefficients, because the elements of a nontrivial finite subgroup of the roots of unity sum to zero. Its continuation has the moduli $|a' + u\,u_{z'} b'|$ at the common successors. Since ϕ depends on the modulus only, consistency is (5.6) on $\mathbb{Z}[C_0]$ for the multiset $(u\,u_{z'})$ of elements of C_0, and Theorem 5.12 applies with q_0 in place of q. The factor is d as in Corollary 5.13, and the converse holds because the rules of the q_0-th roots are restrictions of rules (5.2). □

So on a finite carrier with $\hat{D}$ strongly connected the classification needs no hypothesis on events: the order that matters is q_0, the order of the gains that can meet at one length, which equals q exactly when D and $\hat{D}$ have the same period. This accounts for carriers whose solution spaces are smaller than $\varphi(q)/2$ although their gains generate the whole group; where the gains of closed walks generate a proper subgroup, $\hat{D}$ is not strongly connected and the proposition applies with that subgroup in place of C. The naive statement, that every gain occurs at both vertices at one length whenever $\hat{D}$ is strongly connected, is false: on the four vertices with arcs and exponents $(0, 2, 0)$, $(0, 3, 1)$, $(1, 0, 1)$, $(1, 1, 3)$, $(2, 0, 0)$, $(2, 1, 0)$, $(3, 2, 0)$, $(3, 3, 3)$ for $q = 4$, D is aperiodic, $\hat{D}$ is strongly connected of period 2, and at any length only two of the four gains occur at a vertex. The proposition, its proof and this example were found with a sub-agent after the director's naive version failed; on 660 random carriers of degrees two to four the corrected statement holds wherever its hypotheses do (483), and the naive one fails on exactly the 130 with $r \neq r_0$ [2]. A first version of the program had the coset of y_2 inverted and failed two predicates; it is kept. A challenger found that part (c) as first drafted, for an arbitrary character, was false, by an example with the group $\mathbb{Z}_2 \times \mathbb{Z}_2$; on 473 further carriers it found the dimension $\varphi(q_0)/2$, among them 110 with $q_0 < q$.

5.9 Without the modulus: the block law

So far the rule adds over end vertices a function of the *modulus* of the summed gains. On a carrier with full blocks this restriction is not needed: any function of the summed gains will do, and what consistency then forces is a quadratic form.

Theorem 5.16 (Block law)**.** *Let $q \geq 2$, $d \geq 2$, and let B be a $d \times d$ matrix whose entries are q-th roots of unity, with $B^*B = d$. Let C_B be the group generated by the entries of B, of order q_B. For a function $\Phi\colon R \to \mathbb{R}$ the following are equivalent.*

(i) For all $\beta \in R^d$,

$$\sum_z \Phi\Big(\sum_y B_{zy}\beta_y\Big) = d\sum_y \Phi(\beta_y). \tag{5.7}$$

(ii) Φ is the restriction to R of a real quadratic form Q on V with $Q(ux) = Q(x)$ for every entry u of B, equivalently for every $u \in C_B$.

No invariance of Φ and no condition $\Phi(0) = 0$ is assumed in (i). For $q > 2$, in the coordinates $x_j = \sigma_j$, $j \in J$, the forms in (ii) are the real combinations of $|x_j|^2$, of the real and imaginary parts of $x_j\bar{x}_k$ for $j < k$ with $j \equiv k$ modulo q_B, and of the real and imaginary parts of x_jx_k for $j \leq k$ with $j + k \equiv 0$ modulo q_B. In particular, if Φ satisfies (5.7) *and $\Phi(u\alpha) = \Phi(\alpha)$ for all q-th roots of unity u, or if C_B contains all of them, then $\Phi(\alpha) = \sum_{j\in J} c_j|\sigma_j(\alpha)|^2$ for $q > 2$ and $\Phi(\alpha) = c\,\alpha^2$ for $q = 2$.*

Proof. Multiplication by a root of unity u of R is an orthogonal map $\rho(u)$ of V for the inner product $\sum_j \mathrm{Re}(x_j\bar{y}_j)$. Let $T\colon V^d \to V^d$, $(T\beta)_z = \sum_y B_{zy}\beta_y$. Since $\sigma_j(B)^*\sigma_j(B) = d$ for every j, $T = \sqrt{d}\,U$ with U orthogonal, the block (z, y) of U being $\rho(B_{zy})/\sqrt{d}$; and T maps R^d into itself, as does T^*, the map of the matrix B^*, with $TT^* = d$ because B is square. Write $F(\beta) = \sum_y \Phi(\beta_y)$, so that (5.7) is $F(T\beta) = dF(\beta)$.

(ii) implies (i). Let $Q(x) = \langle x, Mx\rangle$ with M symmetric. Invariance under u is $\rho(u)^{\mathsf{T}}M\rho(u) = M$, that is, $M\rho(u) = \rho(u)M$. Then $1_d \otimes M$ commutes with U, so $F(T\beta) = d\,\langle U\beta, (1\otimes M)U\beta\rangle = d\,\langle\beta, (1\otimes M)\beta\rangle = dF(\beta)$.

Step 1: on every coset of dR, Φ is a polynomial of degree at most two. Write $\Delta_h f(a) = f(a+h) - f(a)$. For $h, h' \in R$ apply to both sides of $F(T\beta) = dF(\beta)$, as functions of β, the mixed difference with the steps h in β_1 and h' in β_2. It annihilates F, which is a sum of functions of one β_y each, and it changes $(T\beta)_z$ by $B_{z1}h$ and $B_{z2}h'$. Hence

$$\sum_z (\Delta_{B_{z1}h}\Delta_{B_{z2}h'}\Phi)((T\beta)_z) = 0 \qquad (\beta \in R^d).$$

Replace β by $\beta + T^*(ke_{z_0})$, $k \in R$: this changes $T\beta$ by dk in the component z_0 only. Subtracting, $(\Delta_{dk}\Delta_{B_{z_01}h}\Delta_{B_{z_02}h'}\Phi)((T\beta)_{z_0}) = 0$. Here $(T\beta)_{z_0}$ takes every value in R (let $\beta = \overline{B_{z_01}}\,a\,e_1$), and $B_{z_01}h$, $B_{z_02}h'$ are arbitrary elements of R. So

$$\Delta_{dk}\Delta_h\Delta_{h'}\Phi = 0 \qquad \text{on } R, \text{ for all } k, h, h' \in R. \tag{5.8}$$

In particular all threefold differences of Φ with steps in dR vanish, so on each coset $c + dR$, a lattice of full rank in V, Φ agrees with a unique real polynomial P_c on V of degree at most two: if all threefold differences of a function on a lattice vanish, its twofold differences are constant, its differences are affine, and it is a polynomial of total degree at most two. Write $P_c = P_c^2 + P_c^1 + P_c^0$ for its homogeneous parts with respect to the origin of V, with $P_c^2(x) = \langle x, M_cx\rangle$, $P_c^1(x) = \langle\ell_c, x\rangle$, $P_c^0 = \kappa_c$; there are finitely many cosets.

Step 2: a polynomial identity for every vector of cosets. Let $c = (c_y) \in (R/dR)^d$ and $c' = Tc$. For β in the coset c of dR^d, $T\beta$ lies in the coset c' and (5.7) reads $\sum_z P_{c'_z}((T\beta)_z) = d\sum_y P_{c_y}(\beta_y)$. Both sides are polynomials in $\beta \in V^d$ and a coset of a lattice of full rank is Zariski dense, so this holds on V^d, and for each degree separately:

$$\sum_z P^i_{c'_z}((T\beta)_z) = d\sum_y P^i_{c_y}(\beta_y) \qquad (\beta \in V^d,\ i = 0, 1, 2). \tag{5.9}$$

Step 3: the parts of degree zero and one vanish. Let $\mu = \max_c |\kappa_c|$, attained at c^*, and take $c = (c^*, \dots, c^*)$ in (5.9) with $i = 0$: the right side has absolute value $d^2\mu$ and the left at most $d\mu$; so $\mu = 0$. For $i = 1$, (5.9) says $T^{\mathsf{T}}\ell' = d\,\ell$ with $\ell = (\ell_{c_y})_y$ and $\ell' = (\ell_{c'_z})_z$; as $T^{\mathsf{T}} = \sqrt{d}\,U^{\mathsf{T}}$, $|\ell'| = \sqrt{d}\,|\ell|$. With $\mu = \max_c |\ell_c|$ attained at c^* and $c = (c^*, \dots, c^*)$, $|\ell| = \sqrt{d}\,\mu$ and $|\ell'| \le \sqrt{d}\,\mu$, so $d\mu \le \sqrt{d}\mu$ and $\mu = 0$.

Step 4: the parts of degree two coincide and are invariant. For $i = 2$, (5.9) is $U^{\mathsf{T}}D'U = D$ with the block diagonal matrices $D = \operatorname{diag}(M_{c_y})$ and $D' = \operatorname{diag}(M_{c'_z})$, that is, $D' = UDU^{\mathsf{T}}$. For $c = 0$ this gives $(1 \otimes M_0)U = U(1 \otimes M_0)$, whose block (z, y) is $M_0\rho(B_{zy}) = \rho(B_{zy})M_0$: the form P_0^2 is invariant under every entry of B. For $c = c_0 e_1$ subtract the case $c = 0$: $D' - 1 \otimes M_0 = U \operatorname{diag}(M_{c_0} - M_0, 0, \dots, 0)U^{\mathsf{T}}$. The left side is block diagonal, and the block (z, z') of the right side is $\frac{1}{d}\rho(B_{z1})(M_{c_0} - M_0)\rho(B_{z'1})^{\mathsf{T}}$. Taking $z \neq z'$, which is possible because $d \ge 2$, and using that the ρ are invertible, $M_{c_0} = M_0$ for every c_0.

Hence $\Phi(a) = \langle a, M_0 a\rangle$ for every $a \in R$, which is (ii). The list of invariant forms follows because the monomials $x_j\bar{x}_k$ and $x_j x_k$ are multiplied by $\zeta^{t(j-k)}$ and $\zeta^{t(j+k)}$ under $u = \zeta^t$; for C_B the full group and $q > 2$, $j \equiv k$ forces $j = k$ in J and $j + k \equiv 0$ is impossible in J, since J contains one of $j, -j$ and $2j \not\equiv 0$. □

Corollary 5.17 (Carriers with a full block)**.** *Let D be a gain digraph with gains in the q-th roots of unity and the faithful character, with a block: $d \ge 2$ vertices $x_0, \dots, x_{d-1}$ whose sets of successors are one set $y_0, \dots, y_{d-1}$, the matrix $B = (A_{y_z x_y})$ satisfying $B^*B = d$. Suppose that for some starting vertex and every N there is a length at which every q-th root of unity is the gain of at least N walks to each x_y. Let $\Phi\colon R \to \mathbb{R}$ be any function with $\Phi(0) = 0$ and $\mu(S) = \sum_y \Phi(v_S(y))$. If μ is consistent under continuation with factor d, then Φ is a real quadratic form invariant under the entries of B. If moreover μ is unchanged by switching, that is, $\Phi(u\alpha) = \Phi(\alpha)$ for every q-th root of unity u, then $\Phi(\alpha) = \sum_{j\in J} c_j|\sigma_j(\alpha)|^2$; and on a carrier with $A^*A = d$ every such rule is consistent.*

Proof. By the hypothesis every $\beta \in R^d$ is the vector of an event with the components β_y at x_y and no others, and its continuation has the components $\sum_y B_{zy}\beta_y$ at y_z and no others. Consistency for these events is (5.7), and Theorem 5.16 applies. The last statement is Lemma 3.1 of [9] for each σ_j. □

Every finite norm-preserving digraph of degree two consists of blocks [9], so for these carriers, where the gains are abundant in the sense of Proposition 5.14, the corollary removes the modulus from the assumptions: a rule that adds over end vertices *any* function of the summed gains, and is unchanged by switching, is a combination of the conjugate squared moduli; for the block of B_q the entries generate all q-th roots of unity and switching invariance is not even needed. The proof is elementary. It uses events with all d inputs: with two inputs only the conclusion is false for $d \ge 3$, since for the Fourier block with $d = q = 3$ the function $\operatorname{Re}(c\,a^3)$ satisfies every two-input instance of (5.7) and is invariant under the cube roots of unity, while it fails with three inputs (the coefficient of $\beta_0\beta_1\beta_2$ in $\sum_z(\beta_0 + \omega^z\beta_1 + \omega^{2z}\beta_2)^3$ is 18). Invariance under all roots cannot be dropped when the entries of B generate a proper subgroup: for a real Hadamard block and $q = 4$ every real quadratic form on $\mathbb{C}$ satisfies (5.7), for instance $\operatorname{Re}(a^2)$. For $d = 1$ only invariance under the single entry is forced. The condition $\Phi(0) = 0$ of the corollary is needed because the rule sums over all vertices; on a finite carrier it follows from consistency for an event whose vector is zero. The theorem and its proof were found by a sub-agent that had been asked a narrower question; each step was rechecked for this paper. Two steps of linear algebra used in it are checked in Lean 4 with Mathlib; exact solutions of (5.7) on boxes for twelve blocks

have the dimension of the invariant forms, and homogeneous polynomial solutions of degrees one to six for fourteen blocks exist only in degree two [2]. Four predicates that expected the two-input equations to suffice failed, as they should, and are kept.

Taken together with Proposition 4.1 this gives the following division, under the assumption that events are sets of histories. A rule of first order is the count and is blind to the gains. A rule of the form (5.1) that is consistent on a finite connected signed norm-preserving carrier of degree two is the squared modulus, and on a norm-preserving carrier in which two walks of equal length merge it is the only consistent power. Where no two walks ever meet, as on a tree, every rule of this form is the count. The second order of the rule of [8] is then a consequence and no longer a separate assumption; the choice of the character is not decided (Theorem 5.5), and it does not arise when the gains are recorded (Corollary 5.7). Among pair rules with a kernel, with no assumption on records beyond the end vertices, the consistent rules are the mixtures of the characters for which the step is norm-preserving (Theorem 5.8), in degree two those in which -1 acts as -1 (Corollary 5.9). The form (5.1), the record role of end vertices and the carrier remain assumed, and rules that are not sums over end vertices of a function of one modulus are not covered.

6 Gains of bounded order and a force

Let U be the normalized step of the signed arc digraph of the line or of a ring, $\mathcal{T}$ the translation by one site, and for a function m of modulus one on the sites let M_m be the multiplication by $m(x)$; UM_m is the step in which every arc leaving site x carries the additional gain $m(x)$. Proposition 6.3 of [9] shows that $m(x) = e^{-i\Phi x}$ translates the quasi-momentum by $-\Phi$ per step.

Proposition 6.1. *$\mathcal{T}\,UM_m\,\mathcal{T}^{-1} = \lambda UM_m$ for a number λ if and only if $m(x-1) = \lambda\, m(x)$ for all x, that is, $m(x) = m(0)\lambda^{-x}$. If m takes its values in a finite group of roots of unity, λ belongs to that group; an exact translation of the quasi-momentum by $\Phi = 2\pi/n$ per step requires gains of order at least n; more precisely the order of the group is a multiple of the order of λ, and on a ring of N sites $\lambda^N = 1$.*

Proof. $\mathcal{T}$ commutes with U and $\mathcal{T}\,M_m\mathcal{T}^{-1}$ is the multiplication by $m(x-1)$; U is invertible. □

With gains of bounded order an exact force is therefore the linear gain of that order, a strong field. A weak mean field can only be approximate, with a gain that winds slowly: constant on long blocks and advancing by one group element from block to block, as in the staircase of [9]. On a block where the gain is the constant γ the step is γU. By Lemma 6.1 of [9] the spectrum of U on the line is

$$\Sigma = \{e^{i\theta} : |\theta| \le \pi/4\} \cup \{e^{i\theta} : |\theta - \pi| \le \pi/4\},$$

two arcs of length $\pi/2$ separated by two gaps of length $\pi/2$.

Proposition 6.2 (Local spectra)**.** *Let $\zeta = e^{2\pi i/q}$. The set $\bigcap_{j=0}^{q-1} \zeta^j \Sigma$ equals Σ for $q = 1, 2$, consists of the four points $e^{\pm i\pi/4}, e^{\pm 3i\pi/4}$ for $q = 4$, and is empty for $q = 3$ and for $q \ge 5$.*

Proof. A point lies in the intersection exactly when its orbit under multiplication by ζ avoids both open gaps. $\Sigma = -\Sigma$ settles $q \le 2$. For $q \ge 5$ consecutive points of an orbit are at angular distance $2\pi/q < \pi/2$, and an open arc of length $\pi/2$ contains one of them. For $q = 4$ the distance is $\pi/2$ and an orbit avoids a gap only by containing

both its end points. For $q = 3$ two of the three points of an orbit would lie in one arc of length $\pi/2$, at distance $2\pi/3$. □

For $q \geq 3$ no quasi-energy is thus an interior point of the spectrum on every block of a staircase that winds through the group; for $q = 4$ the common points are band edges, where the group velocity vanishes. A state that propagates in one block is in a gap of another. This is a statement about the spectra of the pieces. It is not a theorem about the dynamics of the staircase, whose gains are periodic in position, so that the theorem of Grimmett, Janson and Scudo [10] applies with the period as cell and exact confinement is not to be expected. The computed instances are as follows [2].

block length L	1	2	4	16	64
order 2	1108	750	403	346	347
order 3	520	520	160	9.3	31
order 4	750	365	102	8.4	34
order 6	520	181	27	11	48

Table 1: Root-mean-square distance, in sites, after 2048 steps of a walk from one vertex under a staircase of gains of order q with blocks of L sites; $L = 1$ is the linear gain of order q. Ring of 8192 sites; the walk does not reach the far side [2].

Observed. (a) For $L = 1$ the distance doubles between 1024 and 2048 steps: a linear gain with a rational field spreads ballistically, as proved by Cedzich et al. [1]; the bounded distance reported in Section 6.2 of [9] refers to four periods. (b) For $L = 16$ and $L = 64$ and the orders $3, 4, 6$ the walk stays within about one block up to 2048 steps; for $L = 4$ it does not. Order 2 spreads for every L, in accordance with $\Sigma = -\Sigma$. (c) A packet meeting one interface with gain ratio $e^{-i\delta}$ is transmitted with probability 0.9997, 0.9994, 0.975 for $\delta = \pi/12, \pi/6, \pi/4$, with probability 0.0025 for $\pi/3$, below 10^{-12} for $\pi/2$ and $2\pi/3$, and 0.48 for π; the packet has quasi-energy near -0.21, which lies in the shifted band for $\delta < 0.996$. (d) Under a staircase of order 4 a packet is displaced, after an eighth of the period of the mean field, by 0.69, 0.54 and 0.16 of its displacement under the linear gain of the same mean slope, for $L = 16, 64, 256$: the deviation from the mean field grows with the block length. The first two values reproduce those of [9].

Failed expectations, kept. Two predicates fixed before their runs failed. The first expected the staircase of period 64 to drift within 1024 steps; it stayed within four sites of its start. The second expected confinement for $L = 4$. A computation of band velocities from sorted eigenphases returned values above the largest possible speed and below the observed spread, and is discarded as an instrument. All three are in the result files.

In these instances a winding gain of order 3, 4 or 6 either is a strong field, or holds the walk within a block, or leaks slowly; in none does a packet follow the ray of the mean field. Whether some other arrangement of gains of bounded order has a ray limit with a force is not decided.

7 The position of a ray under a linear gain

Table 4 of [9] compares the centroid of a packet with the ray $\dot{k} = -\Phi$, $\dot{x} = v(k)$ through the central quasi-momentum k_0, and reports a deviation of about 0.6 site, most of it the change of the connection $\mathcal{A}(k) = \mathrm{Im}\langle u(k) | \partial_k u(k) \rangle$ of the branch eigenvector. Extending that comparison to longer periods shows that the remainder does not decrease: it is

0.075, 0.038, 0.038, 0.062, 0.117, 0.232 site at the periods 64 to 2048, and a predicate that expected a first-order decrease failed [2]. The cause is the width of the packet in k. If the ray and the connection are averaged over the quasi-momentum distribution ρ of the initial packet,

$$\bar{x}(t) = \sum_{s=1}^{t} \int v(k - (s - \tfrac{1}{2})\Phi)\, \rho(k)\, dk - \int [\mathcal{A}(k - t\Phi) - \mathcal{A}(k)] \rho(k)\, dk, \tag{7.1}$$

with the signs of the conventions of [9], the remainder decreases (Table 2); the fitted exponent against the period is -1.1.

period $2\pi/\Phi$ (steps)	64	128	256	512	1024	2048
ray through k_0, with connection	0.0748	0.0385	0.0381	0.0622	0.1174	0.2315
averaged ray (7.1)	0.0735	0.0273	0.0135	0.0071	0.0029	0.0016

Table 2: Largest deviation, in sites, of the centroid from the prediction over one period. Packet at $k_0 = 1$ on the first branch, width 0.03 in k, ring of 8192 sites. The second row is sampled at 32 times per period. For a packet of width 0.015 the second row gives 0.0075 and 0.0018 at the periods 512 and 2048 [2].

Equation (7.1) is what the adiabatic approximation gives: a vector that stays on one branch has the form $c(k + t\Phi)\, e^{-i\int \omega} u(k)$ in the quasi-momentum representation, in which position is $i\partial_k$, so that the mean position is the mean derivative of the phase plus the mean of $\mathcal{A}$. For an electron in a periodic potential with slowly varying external potentials Panati, Spohn and Teufel prove that the dynamics in an isolated band is governed, to first order in the slowness parameter, by semiclassical equations in which the Berry connection of the band enters [12]. Their theorem concerns Schrödinger operators in continuous time. No corresponding bound is proved here for the step of this paper; the criterion of 0.02 site of [9] is met by the averaged prediction from the period 256 on, and the failed predicate of [9] stands for the ray through k_0.

8 Assumptions and limits

Assumed. (1) Events are sets of histories (Section 3). This replaces “consistency under continuation” in the list of [9] by a statement about events; it is not derived from the carrier. (2) The form (5.1): summed gains at a common end vertex, a function of their modulus, addition over end vertices. (3) The carrier: for Theorems 5.1 and 5.3 a signed norm-preserving digraph of degree two, for Theorem 5.2 a norm-preserving digraph with a merging pair of walks; without merging walks every rule of the form is the count. (4) The group and the character, as in [8].

Obtained under these assumptions. The second order of the rule; the exclusion of first-order weights of returning walks; the classification of the consistent rules of the form (5.1) for gains in the roots of unity as combinations over the conjugate characters; the uniqueness of the rule on the signed lift; the classification of the consistent pair rules with a kernel.

Not obtained. (5) A reason for (1) to (4). Nothing here selects the embedding of the amplitudes: for orders other than $2, 4, 6$ every conjugate character, and every combination, is consistent; multiplicativity on products removes the combinations and leaves the choice among the conjugate characters. On the signed lift there is no such choice (Corollary 5.7); what is then not obtained is a reason for treating one

character as a system, and a reason for or against the gain being a record. Among the pair rules, composition leaves one character in which -1 acts as -1 and does not make it faithful (Corollary 5.9). Nor does anything here select a carrier on which a rule that depends on the gains is consistent: on a digraph of constant out-degree with trivial gains the count is consistent and classical. (6) A classification of consistent rules outside the form (5.1). (7) A ray limit with a force for gains of bounded order, or a proof that there is none; Proposition 6.2 concerns local spectra only. (8) An error bound for (7.1). (9) Everything listed as not obtained in [8, 9]: a clock, a selection of complex amplitudes, composition compatible with the step, and any physical correspondence.

9 Status of the statements

Statement	Kind
Lemmas 3.1, 5.4; Propositions 4.1, 5.6, 5.10, 5.14, 6.1, 6.2; Theorems 5.1, 5.2, 5.3, 5.5, 5.8, 5.11, 5.12, 5.16; Corollaries 5.7, 5.9, 5.13, 5.15, 5.17	derived results, proofs given here
Tables 1, 2; the values in Sections 4, 5, 6, 7	computed instances
Equation (7.1)	heuristic; compared with computed instances; not proved

The components are elementary or known: cylinder sets of histories, the parallelogram identity as a characterization of the square, the isometries of ℓ_p, band spectra of a walk with a piecewise constant phase, and the semiclassical motion in a band with its Berry connection. The paper applies them to the pair measure on a gain digraph and claims no priority. The statements have not been refereed, and the numerical tables are not error enclosures.

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